

Remote Work Policy (2026)

Policy number: POL-HR-007, version 2 **Owner:** Sofia Marques, Head of People **Approved by:** Maya Okafor, CEO **Effective date:** 1 February 2026

This version supersedes the Remote Work Policy (2024), POL-HR-007 version 1, in full. Any reference to a two-day remote allowance in older documents, onboarding decks or Slack messages is out of date.

1. Why we changed the policy

The 2025 engagement survey showed that 78% of employees wanted more flexibility, while office occupancy data showed that Mondays and Fridays were almost empty. The leadership team therefore decided to increase the remote allowance and focus office time on two anchor days with high value.

2. Who this policy applies to

This policy applies to all office-based employees in Lisbon, Berlin, Austin and Kraków. Employees on a fully remote contract are covered by their contract; section 7 explains how they can use the offices.

3. Remote-day allowance

Office-based employees **may work remotely up to 3 days per week**. They are expected in the office on at least **2 days per week**, which should include their team's anchor days.

Item	Rule from 1 February 2026
Remote days per week	Up to 3
Minimum office days per week	2
Default anchor days	Tuesday and Thursday
Carry-over of unused remote days	Not allowed
Temporary extra remote days	Up to 6 weeks with manager approval

Teams may choose different anchor days if the whole team agrees and the department VP is informed. In weeks with a public holiday on an anchor day, the minimum is reduced to one office day.

4. Core hours

Core hours remain **10:00 to 15:00 local office time**. For teams spread across Europe and the US, meetings with both regions should be scheduled between 15:00 and 17:00 Lisbon time where possible.

5. Working from abroad

Working from another country is allowed for up to **20 working days per calendar year** (previously 15), subject to manager approval and a check by the People team. Submit the request in Workday at least 15 working days before travelling. Work from countries under international sanctions, or from countries classified as "extreme" risk by International SOS, is never allowed.

6. Home workplace and security

- You need a quiet, safe workspace and a reliable internet connection.
- Use only your Northwind-managed laptop for work and follow the Information Security Policy, in particular POL-SEC-021 (screen lock and endpoint security).
- Do not work on Confidential or Restricted data on public Wi-Fi without the company VPN (Tailscale).
- Hybrid employees can claim the home internet allowance described in the Expense Policy (POL-FIN-001).

7. Fully remote employees and the offices

Fully remote employees are welcome in any Northwind office. Book a hot desk in the Robin app at least one day in advance. Travel to an office for team events is booked under the Travel Policy (POL-TRV-002).

8. Requesting a different arrangement

Discuss any request with your manager first. Formal requests go through the "Flexible work request" form in Workday; the People team responds within 15 working days. Arrangements based on medical needs are handled confidentially with the People team.

9. Transition

The two-day allowance in the 2024 policy ended on 31 January 2026. Managers had to confirm their team's anchor days in Workday by 15 February 2026.

10. Questions

Ask in Slack #people-help or contact Sofia Marques, Head of People.